

The Garden Party

Katherine Mansfield · 1922

First published: Westminster Gazette, Feb 1922

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Cambridge International edition (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/The_Garden_Party,_and_Other_Stories/The_Garden-Party (revision 14693900), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 10–12 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). Middle School prompts use the full text when the grade tags include 6–8; otherwise teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does The Garden Party suggest about class and privilege?
- What does The Garden Party suggest about life and death?
- What does The Garden Party suggest about coming of age?

Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the story.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

Standards: Cambridge International

CAIE-9695.AO1, CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4, CAIE-9695.AO5

Cambridge International AS & A Level Literature in English 9695 assessment objectives (our summaries; cambridgeinternational.org)

Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one

essay of the five

Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.

Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* The Garden Party	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*class and privilege* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to The Garden Party

Author biography

Katherine Mansfield was born Kathleen Mansfield Beauchamp in Wellington, New Zealand, on 14 October 1888, into a wealthy family. She moved to London at nineteen, lived among modernist writers including Virginia Woolf and D. H. Lawrence, and married the critic John Middleton Murry. Her collections Bliss (1920) and The Garden Party (1922) helped create the modern plotless, impressionistic short story. She died of tuberculosis near Fontainebleau, France, on 9 January 1923, aged 34.

Historical and cultural context

Set in a wealthy suburb of Wellington, New Zealand, modelled on Mansfield's childhood home on Tinakori Road. Colonial New Zealand society kept sharp class divisions; the workmen's cottages lay just below the big houses.

Publication and reception, then and now

First published in the Westminster Gazette (Saturday edition) in February 1922; collected in The Garden Party and Other Stories (1922).

Then: The collection was a critical success in the last year of Mansfield's life.

Now: A classic of modernist short fiction, taught for its shifting point of view, class critique and unresolved epiphany.

Overview (spoiler-free)

The Sheridan family prepares for a lavish garden party. Laura, the youngest daughter, learns that a working man who lived in the cottages nearby has been killed in an accident, and wants to cancel the party.

Main themes

- class and privilege.
- life and death.
- coming of age.

Why it matters

The story asks what we owe neighbours whose lives we don't see.

Spoilers · teacher only

Her mother refuses; after the party Laura takes leftover food to the widow, sees the dead man, and is moved by his peaceful beauty; she can only stammer to her brother, "Isn't life—".

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)

Before we open The Garden Party: Have you ever felt awkward about having something others didn't?
Prompt: Before we open The Garden Party: Have you ever felt awkward about having something others didn't?

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)

free indirect discourse; epiphany; modernism; symbol.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)

About the author. Katherine Mansfield was born Kathleen Mansfield Beauchamp in Wellington, New Zealand, on 14 October 1888, into a wealthy family. She moved to London at nineteen, lived among modernist writers including Virginia Woolf and D. H. Lawrence, and married the critic John Middleton Murry. Her collections Bliss (1920) and The Garden Party (1922) helped create the modern plotless, impressionistic short story. She died of tuberculosis near Fontainebleau, France, on 9 January 1923, aged 34. The world of the book. Set in a wealthy suburb of Wellington, New Zealand, modelled on Mansfield's childhood home on Tinakori Road. Colonial New Zealand society kept sharp class divisions; the workmen's cottages lay just below the big houses. Publication and reception. First published in the Westminster Gazette (Saturday edition) in February 1922; collected in The Garden Party and Other Stories (1922). Then: The collection was a critical success in the last year of Mansfield's life. Now: A classic of modernist short fiction, taught for its shifting point of view, class critique and unresolved epiphany.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)

"Isn't life," she stammered, "isn't life" (The Garden Party, paragraph 187). Her unfinished epiphany.

> *Isn't life," she stammered, "isn't life (The Garden Party, paragraph 187)*

Think-aloud: "Isn't life," she stammered, "isn't life" (The Garden Party, paragraph 187). Her unfinished epiphany.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)

What the book is about (no spoilers): The Sheridan family prepares for a lavish garden party. Laura, the youngest daughter, learns that a working man who lived in the cottages nearby has been killed in an accident, and wants to cancel the party. Themes to track: class and privilege.: life and death.: coming of age.:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)

Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question.
Task: Set up a reading journal for The Garden Party: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Why does The Garden Party still matter? The story asks what we owe neighbours whose lives we don't see.
Anchor question: Why might The Garden Party still be taught today?
Facilitation: The story asks what we owe neighbours whose lives we don't see.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)

Why can't Laura finish her sentence? Answer: Her experience of death and class is too complex for words; the epiphany is unresolved.
Exit ticket: Why can't Laura finish her sentence?
Answer: Her experience of death and class is too complex for words; the epiphany is unresolved.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)

Tomorrow we begin reading: The Garden Party.

Teacher notes · sources: Katherine Mansfield House and Garden, Wellington (https://www.katherinemansfield.com/); Britannica, "Katherine Mansfield" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Katherine-Mansfield); Katherine Mansfield Society (https://www.katherinemansfieldsociety.org/)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- Verify exact date of the Westminster Gazette publication (February 1922 is commonly cited).

Lesson 2: The Garden Party

Focus: a girl's first encounter with death across the class line

Objective: Students will analyze how point of view develops in “The Garden Party” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Content note (death of a working man, viewing a body): Sensitive content: Death of a working man; viewing a body. Preview the story, tell students in advance, and allow a pass on reading aloud. Keep discussion on how the writer uses these elements, not on graphic detail.
Student preview: Heads-up: this story includes death of a working man; viewing a body.
Suggested language: “Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?”

Teacher only · spoilers

The wealthy Sheridans prepare a garden party. Laura learns that a young carter from the poor cottages below, Scott, has been killed, and wants to cancel; her mother and sister refuse. After the party, Laura takes a basket of leftovers to the widow and is led to see the dead man, who looks peaceful and beautiful. She apologizes for her hat and, sobbing, tries to tell her brother Laurie what life is.

Background: Published in 1922 in the Westminster Gazette; Mansfield drew on her childhood in Wellington, New Zealand.

Significance: A modernist story of free indirect discourse and epiphany.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Should a happy event go on when something sad happens nearby? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to class and privilege because.... Content note before we start: Heads-up: this story includes death of a working man; viewing a body.
Prompt: Should a happy event go on when something sad happens nearby?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to class and privilege because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: eyesore — something ugly that spoils a view; meaningly — in a way meant to suggest something unspoken; supervise — to watch over and direct work; ripened — cause to ripen or develop fully; crouched — bend one's back forward from the waist on down. "eyesore": From Middle English eye sor, eie-sor, eyen soore, eæge-sare, equivalent to eye + sore. "meaningly": From Middle English meningli, menyngli, equivalent to meaning + ly.
Words: eyesore: something ugly that spoils a view · meaningly: in a way meant to suggest something unspoken · supervise: to watch over and direct work · ripened: cause to ripen or develop fully · crouched: bend one's back forward from the waist on down

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Published in 1922 in the Westminster Gazette; Mansfield drew on her childhood in Wellington, New Zealand. A modernist story of free indirect discourse and epiphany. Point of view: Free indirect discourse slips into Laura's (and others') voices. Symbolism: Laura's hat, a gift of luxury, marks her class even at the cottage. Irony: The family calls her "absurd" for wanting to cancel. Watch for the hat: class privilege.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "You are being very absurd, Laura" (The Garden Party, paragraph 123). Her mother. That is point of view at work: Free indirect discourse slips into Laura's (and others') voices.

> *You are being very absurd, Laura (The Garden Party, paragraph 123)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "You are being very absurd, Laura" (The Garden Party, paragraph 123). Her mother. That is point of view at work: Free indirect discourse slips into Laura's (and others') voices.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Laura's apology to the dead man. Look at the craft: Laura's hat, a gift of luxury, marks her class even at the cottage. Ask: How does this line connect to class and privilege? Expected: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don't expect sacrifices from us." (Laura's apology to the dead man.)

> *Forgive my hat (The Garden Party, paragraph 178)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Laura's apology to the dead man. Look at the craft: Laura's hat, a gift of luxury, marks her class even at the cottage.
Ask: How does this line connect to class and privilege?
Expected answer: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don't expect sacrifices from us." (Laura's apology to the dead man.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the story for point of view, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Garden Party develops the idea of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. When the text says "You are being very absurd, Laura" (The Garden Party, paragraph 123), it shows this directly. Her mother says "You are being very absurd, Laura," yet at the cottage Laura says "Forgive my hat," aware of her privilege; she finds the dead man "wonderful, beautiful" and cannot express what she has learned.
Task: Annotate the story for point of view, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Garden Party develops the idea of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. When the text says "You are being very absurd, Laura" (The Garden Party, paragraph 123), it shows this directly. Her mother says "You are being very absurd, Laura," yet at the cottage Laura says "Forgive my hat," aware of her privilege; she finds the dead man "wonderful, beautiful" and cannot express what she has learned.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Should a happy event go on when something sad happens nearby? Ask: has Laura changed?
Anchor question: Should a happy event go on when something sad happens nearby?
Facilitation: Ask: has Laura changed?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. ("You are being very absurd, Laura", The Garden Party, paragraph 123). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. ("You are being very absurd, Laura", The Garden Party, paragraph 123). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how point of view shapes a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Key takeaway: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don't expect sacrifices from us."*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Point of view:** Free indirect discourse slips into Laura's (and others') voices.
- **Symbolism:** Laura's hat, a gift of luxury, marks her class even at the cottage.
- **Irony:** The family calls her "absurd" for wanting to cancel.

Themes and how they develop

- **class and privilege:** Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don't expect sacrifices from us."

Symbols and motifs

- **the hat:** class privilege.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "You are being very absurd, Laura" (The Garden Party, paragraph 123) Her mother.
- "Forgive my hat" (The Garden Party, paragraph 178) Laura's apology to the dead man.
- "He was wonderful, beautiful" (The Garden Party, paragraph 176) Her vision of death.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view.
Evidence: "You are being very absurd, Laura" (The Garden Party, paragraph 123)
Reasoning: Her mother says "You are being very absurd, Laura," yet at the cottage Laura says "Forgive my hat," aware of her privilege; she finds the dead man "wonderful, beautiful" and cannot express what she has learned.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
eyesore (noun)	something ugly that spoils a view	*They were the greatest possible eyesore, and they had no right to be in that neighbourhood at all.*	"eyesore": From Middle English eye sor, eie-sor, eyen soore, eæge-sare, equivalent to eye + sore. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/eyesore#Etymology)
meaningly (adverb)		*She said meaningly, "I'm'er sister, miss.*	"meaningly": From Middle English meningli, menyngli, equivalent to meaning + ly.

	in a way meant to suggest something unspoken		(Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/meaningly#Etymology)
supervise (verb)	to watch over and direct work	*But Meg could not possibly go and supervise the men.*	
ripened (verb)	cause to ripen or develop fully	*And the perfect afternoon slowly ripened, slowly faded, slowly its petals closed.*	
crouched (verb)	bend one's back forward from the waist on down	*She crouched down as if to warm herself at that blaze of lilies; she felt they were in her fingers, on her lips, growing in her breast.*	
agreeing (verb)	be in accord; be in agreement	*All the same, they couldn't help agreeing that the puffs looked very attractive.*	"agreeing": From Middle English agreen, from Old French agreer "to accept or receive kindly", from a gré "favorably", from Latin ad "to" + gratum "pleasing", ultimately from Proto-Indo-European *g^{w}erH- "to welcome, greet, praise". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/agree#Etymology)
arranging (verb)	put into a proper or systematic order	*Cook began arranging them, shaking off the extra icing sugar.*	
newspaper (noun)	a daily or weekly publication on folded sheets; contains news and articles and advertisements	*But it all seemed blurred, unreal, like a picture in the newspaper.*	"newspaper": From news + paper. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/newspaper#Etymology)
visited (verb)	called on (someone)	*Hundreds, yes, literally hundreds, had come out in a single night; the green bushes bowed down as though they had been visited by archangels.*	

Discussion questions

1. Should a happy event go on when something sad happens nearby?
2. Where does point of view appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with class and privilege?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What are the Sheridans preparing? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A garden party
2. Who has died? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A young carter, Mr. Scott
3. What does Laura want to do when she hears the news? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Stop the party
4. What does Mrs. Sheridan give Laura to take? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A basket of leftover food
5. What does Laura say to the dead man? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Forgive my hat
6. Retell the three most important events of "The Garden Party" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: The wealthy Sheridans prepare a garden party. Laura learns that a young carter from the poor cottages below, Scott, has been killed, and wants to cancel; her mother and sister refuse. After the party, Laura takes a basket of leftovers to the widow and is led to see the dead man, who looks peaceful and beautiful. She apologizes for her hat and, sobbing, tries to tell her brother Laurie what life…
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "The Garden Party"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "The Garden Party" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: "They were the greatest possible eyesore, and they had no right to be in that neighbourhood at all." What does "eyesore" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: eyesore: something ugly that spoils a view.
10. Reread: "She said meaningly, 'I'm'er sister, miss." What does "meaningly" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · CAIE-9695.AO1] Look for: meaningly: in a way meant to suggest something unspoken.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "The Garden Party" suggest about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A modernist story of free indirect discourse and epiphany.

2. Find one example of point of view in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.
3. How does the imagery in this story shape what we understand about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123): Her mother. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “And after all the weather was ideal.”, why might Mansfield have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “The Garden Party”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: The wealthy Sheridans prepare a garden party. Laura learns that a young carter from the poor cottages below, Scott, has been killed, and wants to cancel; her mother and sister refuse. After the party, Laura takes a basket of leftovers to the widow and is led to see the dead man, who looks peaceful…
6. As the opening story, what does “The Garden Party” set up that the rest of The Garden Party will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “Forgive my hat” (The Garden Party, paragraph 178): Laura's apology to the dead man. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “He was wonderful, beautiful” (The Garden Party, paragraph 176): Her vision of death. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Should a happy event go on when something sad happens nearby?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with class and privilege? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123): Her mother. On irony: The family calls her "absurd" for wanting to cancel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Background: Published in 1922 in the Westminster Gazette; Mansfield drew on her childhood in Wellington, New Zealand. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO2] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “Forgive my hat” (The Garden Party, paragraph 178): Laura's apology to the dead man. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “A modernist story of free indirect discourse and epiphany.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “He was wonderful, beautiful” (The Garden Party, paragraph 176): Her vision of death. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123): Her mother. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “The Garden Party” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “Forgive my hat” (The Garden Party, paragraph 178): Laura's apology to the dead man. On point of view: Free indirect discourse slips into Laura's (and others') voices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “The Garden Party”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “He was wonderful, beautiful” (The Garden Party, paragraph 176): Her vision of death. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this story to life and death: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Mansfield need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123): Her mother. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Is the point of view in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “Forgive my hat” (The Garden Party, paragraph 178): Laura's apology to the dead man. On point of view: Free indirect discourse slips into Laura's (and others') voices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Compare how “The Garden Party” treats a girl's first encounter with death across the class line with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Garden Party see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “He was wonderful, beautiful” (The Garden Party, paragraph 176): Her vision of death. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. As the final story, does this ending resolve class and privilege? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123): Her mother. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “Forgive my hat” (The Garden Party, paragraph 178): Laura's apology to the dead man. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Katherine Mansfield about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “He was wonderful, beautiful” (The Garden Party, paragraph 176): Her vision of death. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “All the same, they couldn’t help _____ that the puffs looked very attractive.” Word bank: meaningly, eyesore, supervise, agreeing
   Key: agreeing
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Laura say to the dead man?
   A. Goodbye
   B. I am sorry you died
   C. Forgive my hat
   D. Rest well
   Key: C (Forgive my hat)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Garden Party, paragraph 123: “You are being very _____, Laura”
   Key: absurd
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who has died?
   A. A gardener
   B. Laura's father
   C. A neighbor's child
   D. A young carter, Mr. Scott
   Key: D (A young carter, Mr. Scott)
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Mrs. Sheridan give Laura to take?
   A. Money
   B. Her hat
   C. A basket of leftover food
   D. Flowers
   Key: C (A basket of leftover food)
6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “But it all seemed blurred, unreal, like a picture in the _____.” Word bank: eyesore, newspaper, meaningly, supervise
   Key: newspaper

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What are the Sheridans preparing?

   A. A wedding

   B. A garden party

   C. A funeral

   D. A dance at a hotel

   Key: B (A garden party)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "She _____ down as if to warm herself at that blaze of lilies; she felt they were in her fingers, on her lips, growing in her breast." Word bank: eyesore, supervise, meaningly, crouched

   Key: crouched

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Cook began _____ them, shaking off the extra icing sugar." Word bank: supervise, meaningly, eyesore, arranging

   Key: arranging

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Laura want to do when she hears the news?

    A. Hide

    B. Visit the cottage at once

    C. Tell Laurie

    D. Stop the party

    Key: D (Stop the party)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "Forgive my hat" (The Garden Party, paragraph 178) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Laura's apology to the dead man.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "The Garden Party"?

    A. Waking into a changed nation

    B. The loss of faith in human goodness

    C. A girl's first encounter with death across the class line

    D. Accepting one's place in nature's cycle

    Key: C (A girl's first encounter with death across the class line)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "You are being very absurd, Laura" (The Garden Party, paragraph 123) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Her mother.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in "The Garden Party"? Laura's hat, a gift of luxury, marks her class even at the cottage.

    A. Symbolism

    B. Hyperbole

    C. Imagery

    D. Point of view

    Key: A (Symbolism)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “He was wonderful, beautiful” (The Garden Party, paragraph 176). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Her vision of death.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Forgive my hat” (The Garden Party, paragraph 178) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Laura's apology to the dead man.
17. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “The Garden Party”? Free indirect discourse slips into Laura's (and others') voices.
    A. Diction / vocabulary
    B. Plot
    C. Allusion
    D. Point of view

    Key: D (Point of view)
18. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123).
    Sample answer: Her mother says "You are being very absurd, Laura," yet at the cottage Laura says "Forgive my hat," aware of her privilege; she finds the dead man "wonderful, beautiful" and cannot express what she has learned.
19. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Her mother.
20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the story: “Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Her mother says "You are being very absurd, Laura," yet at the cottage Laura says "Forgive my hat," aware of her privilege; she finds the dead man "wonderful, beautiful" and cannot express what she has learned.
21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how class and privilege develops from an earlier story to “The Garden Party”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us."
22. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “She said meaningly, “I’m’er sister, miss.”, what does “meaningly” most nearly mean?
    A. something ugly that spoils a view
    B. in a way meant to suggest something unspoken
    C. to watch over and direct work
    D. cause to ripen or develop fully

    Key: B (in a way meant to suggest something unspoken)
23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “And the perfect afternoon slowly ripened, slowly faded, slowly its petals closed.”, what does “ripened” most nearly mean?
    A. in a way meant to suggest something unspoken
    B. to watch over and direct work
    C. something ugly that spoils a view

D. cause to ripen or develop fully

Key: D (cause to ripen or develop fully)

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “But Meg could not possibly go and supervise the men.”, what does “supervise” most nearly mean?

A. in a way meant to suggest something unspoken

B. to watch over and direct work

C. cause to ripen or develop fully

D. something ugly that spoils a view

Key: B (to watch over and direct work)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	6, 8, 9, 3, 7, 2, 4, 10, 5, 13, 12, 11, 17, 15, 18, 19	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	8, 10, 9, 4, 1, 2, 5, 3, 11, 12, 13, 14, 17, 18, 19, 16	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	6, 4, 10, 1, 9, 5, 8, 12, 13, 11, 14, 18, 15, 17, 20, 19	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	5, 3, 7, 10, 9, 4, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	8, 6, 22, 5, 23, 11, 12, 13, 17, 14, 15, 18, 21, 16, 20, 19	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	8, 5, 10, 4, 3, 12, 13, 11, 18, 15, 17, 14, 20, 21, 19, 16	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	6, 8, 4, 7, 23, 12, 11, 13, 18, 15, 17, 14, 16, 20, 19, 21	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	8, 24, 10, 4, 6, 13, 12, 11, 18, 15, 14, 17, 16, 21, 19, 20	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	9, 6, 23, 5, 7, 13, 12, 11, 14, 18, 17, 15, 21, 19, 20, 16	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	4, 8, 23, 24, 6, 11, 13, 12, 18, 14, 17, 15, 19, 16, 20, 21	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Garden Party,” how does Mansfield show a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): In The Garden Party, how does Mansfield develop the idea of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Analyze how The Garden Party develops the idea of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of The Garden Party (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what The Garden Party suggests about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's point of view and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Katherine Mansfield uses point of view in The Garden Party to complicate the reader's understanding of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Situate The Garden Party within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Read The Garden Party alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Garden Party and its treatment of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's point of view and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads The Garden Party as evidence for a larger claim about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line in The Garden Party. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads The Garden Party as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Garden Party.

SAT-style questions

1. *But Meg could not possibly go and supervise the men.*

As used in the text, what does the word "supervise" most nearly mean?

A. to watch over and direct work

B. put into a proper or systematic order

C. a daily or weekly publication on folded sheets; contains news and articles and advertisements

D. called on (someone)

2. *And after all the weather was ideal. They could not have had a more perfect day for a garden-party if they had ordered it. Windless, warm, the sky without a cloud. Only the blue was veiled with a haze of light gold, as it is sometimes in early summer. The gardener had been up since dawn, mowing the lawns and sweeping them, until the grass and the dark flat rosettes where the daisy plants had been seemed to shine. As for the roses, you could not help feeling they understood that roses are the only flowers that impress people at garden-parties; the only flowers that everybody is certain of knowing. Hundreds, yes, literally hundreds, had come out in a single night; the green bushes bowed down as though they had been visited by archangels.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "The Garden Party"?

A. Courage in defense of home

B. Endurance turning to justice

C. A girl's first encounter with death across the class line

D. Racial pride destroying love

SAT key: 1. A (to watch over and direct work); 2. C (A girl's first encounter with death across the class line)

Unit test

The Garden Party: end test · 90 minutes · 18 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Middle School and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Garden Party, paragraph 123: “You are being very _____, Laura”

   Key: absurd

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “But it all seemed blurred, unreal, like a picture in the _____.” Word bank: eyesore, newspaper, meaningly, supervise

   Key: newspaper

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Cook began _____ them, shaking off the extra icing sugar.” Word bank: supervise, meaningly, eyesore, arranging

   Key: arranging

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “All the same, they couldn’t help _____ that the puffs looked very attractive.” Word bank: meaningly, eyesore, supervise, agreeing

   Key: agreeing

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Laura want to do when she hears the news?

   A. Hide

   B. Visit the cottage at once

   C. Tell Laurie

   D. Stop the party

   Key: D (Stop the party)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who has died?

   A. A gardener

   B. Laura's father

   C. A neighbor's child

   D. A young carter, Mr. Scott

   Key: D (A young carter, Mr. Scott)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Mrs. Sheridan give Laura to take?

   A. Money

   B. Her hat

C. A basket of leftover food

D. Flowers

Key: C (A basket of leftover food)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Laura say to the dead man?

   A. Goodbye

   B. I am sorry you died

   C. Forgive my hat

   D. Rest well

   Key: C (Forgive my hat)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “She _____ down as if to warm herself at that blaze of lilies; she felt they were in her fingers, on her lips, growing in her breast.” Word bank: eyesore, supervise, meaningly, crouched

   Key: crouched

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What are the Sheridans preparing?

    A. A wedding

    B. A garden party

    C. A funeral

    D. A dance at a hotel

    Key: B (A garden party)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Her mother.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Forgive my hat” (The Garden Party, paragraph 178) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Laura's apology to the dead man.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “The Garden Party”?

    A. Waking into a changed nation

    B. The loss of faith in human goodness

    C. A girl's first encounter with death across the class line

    D. Accepting one's place in nature's cycle

    Key: C (A girl's first encounter with death across the class line)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “He was wonderful, beautiful” (The Garden Party, paragraph 176). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Her vision of death.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123).

    Sample answer: Her mother says "You are being very absurd, Laura," yet at the cottage Laura says "Forgive my hat," aware of her privilege; she finds the dead man "wonderful, beautiful" and cannot express what she has learned.

16. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “The Garden Party”? Laura's hat, a gift of luxury, marks her class even at the cottage.

    A. Symbolism

    B. Hyperbole

    C. Imagery

    D. Point of view

    Key: A (Symbolism)

17. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “The Garden Party”? Free indirect discourse slips into Laura's (and others') voices.

    A. Diction / vocabulary

    B. Plot

    C. Allusion

    D. Point of view

    Key: D (Point of view)

18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Forgive my hat” (The Garden Party, paragraph 178) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Laura's apology to the dead man.

19. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how class and privilege develops from an earlier story to “The Garden Party”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us."

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Her mother.

21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the story: “Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Her mother says "You are being very absurd, Laura," yet at the cottage Laura says "Forgive my hat," aware of her privilege; she finds the dead man "wonderful, beautiful" and cannot express what she has learned.

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “But Meg could not possibly go and supervise the men.”, what does “supervise” most nearly mean?

    A. in a way meant to suggest something unspoken

    B. to watch over and direct work

    C. cause to ripen or develop fully

    D. something ugly that spoils a view

    Key: B (to watch over and direct work)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “She said meaningly, “I’m’er sister, miss.”, what does “meaningly” most nearly mean?

    A. something ugly that spoils a view

    B. in a way meant to suggest something unspoken

    C. to watch over and direct work

    D. cause to ripen or develop fully

Key: B (in a way meant to suggest something unspoken)

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "And the perfect afternoon slowly ripened, slowly faded, slowly its petals closed.", what does "ripened" most nearly mean?

    A. in a way meant to suggest something unspoken

    B. to watch over and direct work

    C. something ugly that spoils a view

    D. cause to ripen or develop fully

    Key: D (cause to ripen or develop fully)

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "They were the greatest possible eyesore, and they had no right to be in that neighbourhood at all.", what does "eyesore" most nearly mean?

    A. cause to ripen or develop fully

    B. in a way meant to suggest something unspoken

    C. something ugly that spoils a view

    D. to watch over and direct work

    Key: C (something ugly that spoils a view)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	3, 8, 2, 7, 9, 5, 1, 10, 6, 4, 12, 11, 13, 17, 15, 16, 14, 18	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	5, 10, 4, 7, 1, 6, 9, 3, 2, 8, 12, 11, 13, 17, 15, 14, 18, 19	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	1, 2, 10, 7, 8, 4, 6, 3, 9, 13, 12, 11, 17, 14, 16, 15, 20, 21	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	10, 4, 5, 9, 1, 2, 6, 8, 12, 11, 13, 16, 14, 17, 15, 20, 19, 18	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	5, 1, 3, 7, 8, 22, 10, 13, 12, 11, 16, 14, 15, 17, 18, 21, 19, 20	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	3, 8, 23, 2, 6, 24, 5, 11, 12, 13, 15, 17, 16, 14, 21, 20, 18, 19	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	5, 25, 8, 4, 6, 10, 1, 13, 11, 12, 15, 14, 16, 17, 21, 20, 19, 18	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	2, 1, 8, 24, 22, 5, 10, 11, 12, 13, 16, 17, 14, 15, 21, 19, 20, 18	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	9, 3, 22, 1, 8, 5, 6, 12, 11, 13, 16, 15, 17, 14, 20, 18, 19, 21	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	3, 5, 6, 4, 1, 22, 25, 11, 12, 13, 15, 16, 17, 14, 20, 21, 19, 18	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Final paper

The Garden Party: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Katherine Mansfield develops class and privilege across The Garden Party. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in The Garden Party and argue how its meaning changes over the story and why that change matters to life and death.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in The Garden Party. Argue whether the story judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether The Garden Party finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of coming of age. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Middle School 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 4 quotations from at least two parts of the story. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.
Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.

Essay assignments

Essay: Class and privilege

Middle School (600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Garden Party teaches about class and privilege. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Katherine Mansfield develops class and privilege in The Garden Party. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Katherine Mansfield develops class and privilege across The Garden Party. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Garden Party (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of class and privilege. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of class and privilege in The Garden Party. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Katherine Mansfield's choices in The Garden Party (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of class and privilege, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Garden Party's treatment of class and privilege in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on class and privilege in The Garden Party that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on class and privilege in The Garden Party. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about class and privilege in The Garden Party, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on class and privilege in The Garden Party, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Life and death

Middle School (600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Garden Party teaches about life and death. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Katherine Mansfield develops life and death in The Garden Party. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Katherine Mansfield develops life and death across The Garden Party. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Garden Party (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of life and death. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of life and death in The Garden Party. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Katherine Mansfield's choices in The Garden Party (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of life and death, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Garden Party's treatment of life and death in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on life and death in The Garden Party that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on life and death in The Garden Party. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about life and death in The Garden Party, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on life and death in The Garden Party, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Coming of age

Middle School (600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Garden Party teaches about coming of age. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Katherine Mansfield develops coming of age in The Garden Party. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Katherine Mansfield develops coming of age across The Garden Party. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Garden Party (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of coming of age. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of coming of age in The Garden Party. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Katherine Mansfield's choices in The Garden Party (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of coming of age, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Garden Party's treatment of coming of age in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on coming of age in The Garden Party that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on coming of age in The Garden Party. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about coming of age in The Garden Party, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Cambridge International: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on coming of age in The Garden Party, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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